SAI GUNTUPALLI

SENIOR DATA ENGINEER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- Senior Data Engineer and team lead with 10 years of experience building scalable, observable data platforms across media, streaming, and financial services.
- At Disney, lead a team of 8 engineers owning the marketing data platform behind econometric models that guide $100M+ in annual marketing spend, processing 50–60 million attribution events daily.
- Builds AI-enabled engineering tooling, config-driven ETL, and data-quality frameworks on PySpark, Airflow, Snowflake, Databricks, AWS, and GCP.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, Scala, Java, Shell

Data Engineering: PySpark, Spark Scala, Snowflake, Databricks (Unity Catalog), Apache Airflow, Delta Lake, Iceberg, Apache Flink, PyDeequ, Fivetran

Cloud Platforms: Amazon Web Services (Lambda, S3, EMR, Step Functions, SNS, SES, CloudWatch, Kinesis), Google Cloud Platform (GCP)

Generative AI and Agentic Tooling: Claude (API, agent skills), AI-assisted code review and migrations, Cursor, agentic workflows, prompt engineering

DevOps and Observability: Terraform, Docker, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, CI/CD, PagerDuty, SLA monitoring

CERTIFICATIONS

Claude Certified Architect – Foundations | Anthropic | Oct 2026
NVIDIA Generative AI LLMs Certification | NVIDIA | Nov 2025
GCP Professional Data Engineer | Google Cloud | Jul 2025
Databricks Certified Data Engineer Associate | Databricks | Mar 2023

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

The Walt Disney Company Aug 2022 – Present
Role: Senior Data Engineer, Team Lead

- Lead a team of 8 engineers owning the end-to-end marketing data platform that feeds econometric models guiding $100M+ in annual marketing spend.
- Built and operated the MMM (marketing mix modeling) repository, ingesting paid-media data sources across US, EMEA, APAC, and LATAM as the source of truth for Marketing Science teams.
- Refactored the Event Level Attribution Platform tracking ad click to subscription journeys for Disney+ and ESPN+, processing 50–60 million events daily and cutting typical 6-month backfills from about a week to 3–4 hours.
- Enhanced the team's shared Python framework, a config-driven ingestor reading from 6+ input source types, and added a config-driven data-quality (DQ) framework used across 8+ pipelines.
- Designed the canonical data model for Project Armory, a canonical ESPN marketing data model across Paid Media, Lifecycle, Synergy, and GAM, consolidating 20+ legacy notebooks and 10+ sources with built-in error handling and quality checks across 10+ pipelines.
- Developed AirBoard, a DAG monitoring dashboard with SLA status, alerts, run history, lineage, and a leadership view, covering 100+ DAGs across Acquisition teams.

- Created a shared AI agent-skill framework for migrations, code review, and PR/Jira generation, plus a Databricks optimizer skill that analyzes cluster configurations and run logs to recommend tuned settings, adopted by all Acquisition teams.

Environment: PySpark, SQL, Snowflake, Databricks, Unity Catalog, Delta Lake, Iceberg, Apache Airflow, Amazon S3, AWS Lambda, Terraform, YAML, Fivetran, PyDeequ, PagerDuty, GitHub Actions, Claude and AI agent tooling

NBCUniversal Oct 2021 – Jul 2022

Role: Senior Data Engineer

Project: Media audience measurement and revenue reporting pipelines.

- Optimized Python and Spark pipelines for TAMI (Total Audience Measurement), improving processing speed by 70% and automating manual workflows with AWS Lambda and Step Functions.
- Re-engineered RevDash revenue-dashboard pipelines, cutting runtime from 12 hours to 3 hours.
- Migrated the environment to Spark 3 to process larger volumes on smaller clusters, and rewrote complex business logic from Python to Spark Scala for higher throughput.

Environment: Python, Spark, SQL, Spark Scala, AWS Lambda, AWS Step Functions

Experian Jan 2019 – Sep 2021

Role: Data Engineer

Project: Credit-bureau data pipelines for USAA Bank supporting eligibility decisions for financial products.

- Orchestrated Spark jobs in Apache Airflow, improving reliability of data delivery to analytical models.
- Automated cluster monitoring and data validation with Python and Shell, reducing manual oversight by 25%.
- Partnered with data scientists to modularize feature-engineering pipelines for easier maintenance and reuse.

Environment: Apache Spark, SQL, Apache Airflow, Python, Shell Scripting

Twitch Jul 2018 – Dec 2018

Role: Data Engineer

Project: Real-time streaming engagement alerting for live-streaming operations.

- Engineered a real-time alerting system for live-streaming engagement data with Apache Flink and AWS Kinesis, using Python Lambda functions to notify Slack and email when thresholds were breached.

Experian May 2017 – Jun 2018

Role: Software Engineer

Project: CrossCore backend services integrating third-party fraud-detection providers.

- Developed Java backend services for the CrossCore platform, integrating third-party fraud-detection services and mapping data between systems with XML and JSON.

Environment: Java, XML, JSON, backend services, fraud detection integrations

Tavant Oct 2016 – Apr 2017

Role: Project Trainee

- Trained in Python, Java, and Hadoop (Hive, Sqoop, Spark) on simulated data-ingestion projects.

EDUCATION

B.Tech in Computer Science and Engineering | Gudlavalleru Engineering College, Vijayawada | 2012 – 2016